

HACCP PLAN

Ready-to-eat, heat-treated, shelf-stable beef jerky

Written in the order of the FSIS Guidebook for the Preparation of HACCP Plans

CARNE SECA JESUS CANALES, LLC

411 E Main St, Delta, UT 84624

This plan is specific to this plant and this jerky. It is not a copy of a generic model. The generic model is an example. FSIS says the model is not to be used as-is, and that the establishment tailors it to its own operation.

Document	How this plan uses it
9 CFR Part 417 (2020 edition, govinfo)	This is the regulation. The plan has a hazard analysis, a flow chart, the intended use, critical limits, monitoring, corrective actions, records with the actual numbers, verification, a signature, and pre-shipment review.
FSIS Guidebook for the Preparation of HACCP Plans, FSIS-GD-2020-0008	The sections below follow the guidebook's preliminary steps and the seven principles. The guidebook's worksheets are optional. The regulation is not optional.
FSIS HACCP Model for Ready-to-Eat, Heat-Treated, Shelf-Stable Beef Jerky, 2021-0004	The two critical control points and their limits are the ones in that model: cooking, then drying. The model's example product is cured and contains soy sauce. This jerky is not that product. The differences are in Section 2.
FSIS Cooking Guideline, Revised Appendix A, December 2021, FSIS-GD-2021-14	The model says its cooking critical limit comes from Appendix A. The 145°F for 4 minutes, the sealed-oven humidity, and the come-up time come from that guideline.
Jerky field verification checklist	The checklist's cooler limit, below 41°F, is the prerequisite limit in Section 1. The checklist's drying limit, water activity below 0.88, is met by the stricter model limit of 0.85 or less.

Guidelines on the FSIS index that this plan uses

The page at fsis.usda.gov/policy/fsis-guidelines is a list of guidance. Guidance is not the regulation. 9 CFR Part 417 is the regulation. The guidelines below are the ones on that list that apply to this ready-to-eat, heat-treated, shelf-stable beef jerky. Each one is kept with the plan when the establishment has the copy.

Guideline on the FSIS list	What this plan takes from it
Guidebook for the Preparation of HACCP Plans, FSIS-GD-2020-0008	The order of this plan: prerequisites, product description, ingredients, flow chart, hazard analysis, then the seven principles.
HACCP Model for Ready-to-Eat, Heat-Treated, Shelf-Stable Beef Jerky, 2021-0004	CCP 1 is cooking. CCP 2 is drying. The critical limits in Section 5 are the limits in that model, tailored to this uncured jerky.
Compliance Guideline for Meat and Poultry Jerky Produced by Small and Very Small Establishments, 2014-0010	Humidity is applied during the cook, before drying. Water activity, not the moisture-to-protein ratio, is the safety measurement for the finished jerky.
Cooking Guideline for Meat and Poultry Products, Revised Appendix A, December 2021 (2021-0014)	145°F for at least 4 minutes, the sealed-oven humidity option, and a come-up of 6 hours or less between 50°F and 130°F.
Compliance Guideline: HACCP Systems Validation, 2015-0011	Validation has two parts: the scientific support, and in-plant records showing this oven meets the limits. The validation date stays blank until those records exist. 9 CFR 417.4.
Stabilization Guideline, Revised Appendix B, December 2021 (2021-0013)	The jerky model cites this guideline for the water-activity level that limits <i>Clostridium perfringens</i> and <i>Clostridium botulinum</i> . This plan does not add a cooling critical control point. Those sporeformers are controlled by drying at 170°F or above until the finished water activity is 0.85 or less.
Compliance Guideline: Controlling <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> in Post-lethality Exposed Ready-to-Eat Meat and Poultry Products, 2014-0001	The jerky is handled after the cook, so it is post-lethality exposed. Water activity of 0.85 or less is below the growth minimum for <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> . The sanitation SOP names the 9 CFR 430.4 alternative before any lot ships.

Other guidelines on that index, including slaughter, raw ground beef, and canned products, are not the process in this plant. They are not part of this plan. If the formula later adds an allergen or a nitrite cure, the allergen guideline and 9 CFR 424.22 are added and the hazard analysis is reassessed.

1. Preliminary steps

1.1 Prerequisite programs

These procedures keep some hazards from being reasonably likely to occur. Each one is written, and the record is kept with this plan (9 CFR 417.5(a)).

- Sanitation SOP. Food-contact surfaces are cleaned before slicing and before packing. The result is written as clean or not clean.
- Temperature control. Raw beef for this jerky stays below 41°F (5°C), measured in the meat. The FSIS model uses a prerequisite of below 45°F (Tompkin, 1996) and does not make cold storage a critical control point. This plan uses 41°F, which is colder than 45°F, because that is the limit on the jerky field checklist.
- Receiving. Beef is from an inspected source. The invoice and the mark of inspection are kept. Spices and bags have a specification.
- Employee hygiene. A person who is ill does not handle meat or jerky. Hands are washed. Bare hands do not touch finished jerky.
- Equipment check. The slicer is looked at before use. A damaged blade stops the work. This plant does not claim a history of metal-detector results, because that history is not on file.
- Allergen and ingredient control. The batch sheet lists every ingredient and its weight. Nothing in this formula is a major allergen. Nitrite is not used.
- Ready-to-eat area. After the cook, jerky is handled only in the clean pack area. The bag is not wetted.
- Returned product. An opened bag is not taken back into production. If returned product is accepted, the local FSIS office is told.
- Recall. Written recall procedures are kept, as required by 9 CFR 418.3. If adulterated product from this plant has entered commerce, the local FSIS District Office is notified within 24 hours (9 CFR 418.2).

1.2 HACCP team

9 CFR 417.7: the person who develops this plan, and the person who reassesses it, must have completed a course in the seven HACCP principles for meat or poultry, including a HACCP plan for a specific product and record review. That person does not have to be an employee.

HACCP-trained person: _____

Course and date: _____

Responsible establishment official: Jesús Canales _____

1.3 Product description — guidebook worksheet 1

Guidebook question	This product
Common name	Beef jerky (carne seca), ready to eat, heat-treated, shelf-stable.
Composition	Whole-muscle beef, salt, and only these spices if the batch sheet shows a weight: black pepper, garlic powder, onion powder, paprika. Uncured. No nitrite, no nitrate, no erythorbate, no sugar, no soy, no wheat. Not fermented. Water activity of the finished jerky: 0.85 or less. pH is not a control.
Ready-to-eat?	Yes. The customer does not cook it. 9 CFR 417.2(a)(2).
Where sold, and who eats it	Household consumers, including children, older adults, and immunocompromised people. Also restaurants or stores if a lot is sold there.
Intended use	Eaten as sold. No further cooking.
Package and storage	Food-grade moisture-barrier bag, heat-sealed, lot code on the bag. Stored and shipped at ambient temperature. The bag stays dry. This plan does not claim a vacuum package unless the batch sheet says that bag was vacuum sealed.
Shelf life	Unopened, not refrigerated. The number of days is written here after this plant's own holding records support it: _____ days. The model's example of 240 days is for the model's cured, vacuum-packed product. It is not copied onto this jerky.
Label statements	Product name, ingredients, net weight, name and place of business, lot code. No allergen statement, because this formula has none of the major allergens. Inspection legend and establishment number are applied when the plant is under inspection.
Special distribution controls	None for temperature. A wet or open bag is not sold.
Process category	Heat-treated — shelf stable. 9 CFR 417.2(b)(1)(vi). The guidebook names meat jerky as the example of this category.

1.4 Ingredients and incoming materials — guidebook worksheet 2

Item	This plant
Meat	Inspected boneless beef, whole muscle.
Other food ingredients	Salt. Black pepper, garlic powder, onion powder, and paprika only when the batch sheet shows a weight.
Antimicrobials and processing aids	None.
Restricted ingredients	None. Sodium nitrite is not used. The model's footnote 2 says jerky may be cured or uncured and that sodium nitrite is not required.
Allergens	None in this formula. Soy sauce is not used. The model's example contains soy and wheat. This product does not.
Packaging	Food-grade moisture-barrier bags.

1.5 Process flow — guidebook worksheet 3

9 CFR 417.2(a)(2) requires a flow chart of the steps. The order below is the plant's order. It follows the model's order and leaves out steps this plant does not have.

- 1. Receive inspected beef. Check the mark of inspection and the product temperature.
- 1a. Receive salt, spices, and bags. Check the specification.
- 2. Cold storage. Product temperature below 41°F. Prerequisite, not a CCP.
- 3. Slice. Record the thickness.
- 4. Weigh and mix the ingredients on the batch sheet.
- 5. Marinate in the cooler, still below 41°F. Drain. Single layer on racks. Do not stack. Do not dry before the cook.

- 6. Cooking — CCP 1, the lethality step.
- 7. Drying — CCP 2.
- 8. Cool dry. Do not rinse or mist. Pack and label in the ready-to-eat area.
- 9. Dry storage and distribution.
- 10. Returned product, if any. Separate from the main flow. Opened bags are not reused.

The flow chart is verified by walking the plant. Name and date of that walk-through:

Name and date: _____

There is no metal-detector step in this flow. There is no brine step, no fermentation step, and no ingredient added after CCP 1.

1.6 Label — FSIS Guideline for Label Approval

The current guideline is FSIS-GD-2025-0006, December 2025. It replaces the earlier FSIS Guideline for Label Approval. It tells the plant when a label must be sent to the Labeling and Program Delivery Staff (LPDS) before it is used. The labeling rules themselves are in 9 CFR parts 317, 319, and 412. A product without an acceptable label is not sold.

This jerky's basic label has no special claim. Under 9 CFR 412.2 that label is generically approved. It is not sent to LPDS before use, as long as every required feature is present and true. The inspector can still check it. LPDS sketch approval, 9 CFR 412.1(c), is required only for a religious-exempt label, a label with a special statement or claim, or a temporary approval.

On this bag	Rule
Product name	Beef Jerky. English is required. "Carne seca" may be added and does not replace "Beef Jerky."
Ingredients	In descending order by weight, for that lot: beef, salt, and only the spices that were weighed. The label matches the batch sheet. 9 CFR 317.2.
Net weight	The weight of the jerky in that bag.
Name and place of business	Carne Seca Jesus Canales, LLC, 411 E Main St, Delta, UT 84624.
Inspection legend and establishment number	Applied when the plant is under federal inspection. The number is written on the label when it is issued.
Lot code	On the bag, so the HACCP records can be found. 9 CFR 417.5.
Nutrition Facts	Required unless this plant meets the small-business exemption in 9 CFR 317.400. The exemption is checked before the first sale. It is not assumed.
Safe-handling label for raw meat	Not used. This jerky is ready to eat. That label is for raw or partially cooked product.
Keep refrigerated	Not used. The finished water activity is 0.85 or less, so the jerky is shelf-stable. The 2014 jerky guideline says "Refrigerate After Opening" when a vacuum bag is above 0.85 and at or below 0.91. This plan does not use that range.

These words are not printed on this label. Each one is a special statement or a negative claim under the guideline, and each one needs its own support or an LPDS review. Adding one of them changes the approval.

- Natural, organic, certified gluten-free, no antibiotics, grass-fed.

- Product of USA, Made in the USA, or a U.S. flag. Those are voluntary origin claims under 9 CFR 412.3. The December 2025 guideline says the support for that claim has to be on file. This plan does not make the claim.
- Uncured. Jerky is allowed without nitrite, so the word is not required. On a product people expect to be cured, “uncured” is tied to “Not preserved — keep refrigerated,” which would contradict this shelf-stable jerky.
- No preservatives, or no nitrite, until the ingredients statement and the guideline’s negative-claim examples have been checked for that exact wording.

The name “Beef Jerky” also has a standard of identity. The moisture-to-protein ratio is 0.75:1 or less. That ratio is checked on validation lots for the name on the bag. It is not a critical limit. Water activity remains the safety limit.

Before a lot ships, the packer checks the bag against the batch sheet: the name is Beef Jerky, the ingredients match the weights, the net weight is on the bag, the address is on the bag, and none of the claims in the list above were added. A bag that fails that check is not sold.

2. What was changed from the FSIS jerky model

Model example	This establishment
Cured with sodium nitrite and sodium erythorbate	Uncured. No nitrite. Footnote 2 of the model allows uncured jerky.
Soy sauce, so the example has soy and wheat allergens	No soy and no wheat. No allergen in the formula.
Sugar and a flavor mixture	Salt and the spices named on the batch sheet only.
Vacuum-packed, 240 days	Heat-sealed moisture-barrier bag. Shelf-life days are filled in from this plant’s records.
Cold storage prerequisite below 45°F	Prerequisite below 41°F, which also meets the field checklist.
Metal detection, supported by that plant’s history	Not in this plan. This plant does not have that history on file.
CCP 1 cooking and CCP 2 drying	Same two CCPs, same limits, written in Section 5.

3. Principle 1 — Hazard analysis

9 CFR 417.2(a). A hazard reasonably likely to occur is one a prudent plant would control because it has happened, or because it could happen in this kind of product if it is not controlled. Hazards are biological, chemical, or physical (guidebook, Principle 1).

Step	Hazard	RLTO?	Basis	Control	CCP?
1 Beef receiving	B: STEC, Salmonella	Yes	Raw beef can carry these pathogens. The model treats this as reasonably likely.	Killed at CCP 1 if the cooking limits are met.	No. Later step.
1 Beef receiving	B: BSE prion	No	Inspected beef. Specified risk materials are not in this cut.	Receiving record.	No
1 Beef receiving	P: Foreign material	No	Containers and meat are looked at when they arrive.	Receiving record.	No
1a Spices	B: Salmonella	Yes	A spice can carry Salmonella. It is mixed in before the cook.	Killed at CCP 1. Nothing is added after CCP 1.	No. Later step.
1a Spices	C: Allergen or nitrite	No	The formula has no major allergen and no nitrite. A delivery that does not match the specification is rejected.	Batch sheet and specification.	No

1a Bags	C: Not food grade	No	Bags are food grade, from the specification.	Receiving record.	No
2 Cold storage	B: Outgrowth	No	Product stays below 41°F, which is colder than the model's 45°F prerequisite (Tompkin, 1996). The cook is not used to fix warm raw beef.	Temperature log.	No
3 Slice	B: Higher load from abuse	No	Slicing stays under the temperature procedure so the load is not higher than the cook is designed to reduce.	Temperature log and thickness on the batch sheet.	No
3 Slice	P: Metal from the slicer	No	The blade is checked before use. This decision does not rest on metal-detector history.	Equipment check.	No
5 Marinate	B: Outgrowth	No	Marination stays below 41°F.	Temperature log.	No
6 Cooking	B: STEC, Salmonella, L. monocytogenes	Yes	Raw beef may be contaminated. The model's control is a cook that achieves at least a 5.0-log reduction of Salmonella and at least a 5.0-log reduction of STEC, with humidity so the surface does not dry first.	CCP 1.	Yes. CCP 1
7 Drying	B: C. perfringens and C. botulinum outgrowth; S. aureus toxin; L. monocytogenes during storage	Yes	The model: drying while water activity is still high can allow sporeformers to grow, and a finished water activity above 0.85 can allow S. aureus to grow and make toxin. L. monocytogenes can grow during storage if water activity stays at or above 0.92.	CCP 2.	Yes. CCP 2
8 Pack	B: L. monocytogenes after the cook	No	Sanitation and no bare-hand contact in the pack area. Growth during storage is prevented by CCP 2, because 0.85 is below 0.92. The 9 CFR 430.4 alternative and any surface-testing schedule are written in the sanitation SOP before this plan is the authority to ship.	Sanitation log and CCP 2.	No
9 Storage	B: Rehydration	No	Dry storage. A wet or open bag is not sold.	Distribution log.	No
10 Returned product	B: Unknown holding	No	Opened bags are rejected. Accepted returns are held and the FSIS office is notified.	Return record.	No

4. Principle 2 — Why these two steps are the CCPs

The guidebook's decision questions, applied to the two hazards that need a CCP:

Question	Cooking	Drying	Cold storage
Can a control be applied here?	Yes. Time, temperature, and humidity.	Yes. Oven temperature and water activity.	Yes. Keep the meat cold.
Does this step eliminate the hazard or reduce it to an acceptable level?	Yes. This is CCP 1.	Yes. This is CCP 2.	No. Cold holding does not kill the bacteria that are already there.
Will a later step do that?	No later step replaces the cook. Drying is not a substitute for the cook.	No later step replaces the drying limit.	Yes. CCP 1 addresses the pathogens, if the meat was kept cold so the load did not grow.
Decision	CCP 1	CCP 2	Not a CCP. Prerequisite below 41°F.

5. Principles 3, 4, and 5 — Limits, monitoring, corrective actions

9 CFR 417.2(c)(3) through (c)(5). Critical limits come from the FSIS jerky model, which cites Appendix A. The scientific support for each number is named in the table. 9 CFR 417.3: a deviation identifies the cause, brings the point back under control, prevents it from happening again, and keeps injurious product out of commerce.

CCP 1 — Cooking (lethality), before drying

Hazards: STEC (O157:H7, O26, O45, O103, O111, O121, and O145), Salmonella, and Listeria monocytogenes. All of the limits below are required. Drying does not start until this CCP has passed.

Critical limit	Where that criterion is written	Monitoring
Internal temperature at least 145°F for at least 4 minutes, in every part of the meat. The probe is in the thickest piece, in the coldest part of the oven. Readings are not averaged.	Jerky model CCP 1, from Appendix A. Appendix A gives 145°F a dwell of 4 minutes for meat when humidity and come-up time are also met.	Each lot, at the end of the cook. The monitor writes the temperature, the time it reached 145°F, and the time it had held at least 4 minutes.
Wet-bulb temperature at least 125°F for at least 1 hour.	Jerky model CCP 1. The model also allows the plant to record this with relative humidity.	Each lot. Start time, and the readings that show the hour was met.
Relative humidity at least 27 percent for at least 1 hour.	Jerky model CCP 1, which points to the jerky compliance guideline's sealed-oven example.	Each lot, from the wet-bulb and dry-bulb readings, or from a humidity sensor. The number is written.
Oven dampers closed, and the oven sealed, for 50 percent of the cooking time or 1 hour, whichever is longer. Dampers are closed within 30 minutes after the product is placed in the heated oven.	Jerky model CCP 1 and the hazard analysis: dampers close within 30 minutes so the surface does not dry and make Salmonella harder to kill. Appendix A Humidity Option 2 is a sealed oven for 50 percent of the cook or 1 hour, whichever is longer.	Each lot. Time the meat went into the heated oven, time the dampers closed, and time the dampers opened.
Come-up: the internal temperature is between 50°F and 130°F for 6 hours or less.	Appendix A, pages 23–24, which the model names as the source of the cooking limit. This option keeps Staphylococcus aureus growth to about 2-log or less and is the option that prevents enterotoxin during the come-up.	Each lot. Time the internal temperature passed 50°F and time it passed 130°F.

Who monitors: the trained designee, at the time of the reading. The entry has the date, the time, and the initials (9 CFR 417.5(b)).

If any CCP 1 limit is missed: the designee stops the lot and tells Jesús Canales. The lot is held. It does not go to drying and it does not ship. The cause is written. The oven is corrected before the next lot. Product that missed the cook is not sold as ready-to-eat jerky. A laboratory test is not the release step. This is the corrective action required by 9 CFR 417.3(a).

CCP 2 — Drying, after CCP 1 has passed

Critical limit	Where that criterion is written	Monitoring
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Oven temperature setting at least 170°F during drying, read with the dry-bulb thermometer.	Jerky model CCP 2. The model uses this temperature so <i>Clostridium perfringens</i> and <i>Clostridium botulinum</i> do not grow while the water activity is still above 0.93.	Each lot. The dry-bulb reading during drying, before the jerky is taken out of the oven.
Finished water activity 0.85 or less. At least six pieces, taken from different places in the lot, including a thick piece. The highest reading is the lot result. Every piece checked is 0.85 or less.	Jerky model CCP 2: dry to a water activity of 0.85 or less so <i>Staphylococcus aureus</i> does not grow and make toxin, and so <i>Listeria monocytogenes</i> does not grow in storage (its growth minimum is below 0.92). The model checks at least six pieces. The product-description line in the model says water activity below 0.85. This plan uses 0.85 or less, and the highest piece must not be above 0.85.	Each lot, after drying, before packing. Calibrated water-activity meter.

Water activity is the safety measurement. The moisture-to-protein ratio is the standard of identity for the name “jerky” (the model’s footnote 31, often 0.75:1 or less). It is checked during validation for labeling. It is not the critical limit.

If the oven is below 170°F, or if any of the six readings is above 0.85: do not pack. The lot is held. Jesús Canales is told. If CCP 1 passed, the lot may be dried longer at 170°F or above and measured again. If it still fails, it does not ship. It is not wetted and cooked again under this plan.

6. Principle 6 — Verification

9 CFR 417.4.

- Initial validation. The scientific support is the jerky model, Appendix A, and the pages cited above. The in-plant part is repeated lots on this oven, this load, and this thickness, showing that CCP 1 and CCP 2 were met. The validation date below stays blank until those logs have been reviewed. 9 CFR 417.4(a)(1).
- Calibration. Product probe, dry bulb, and wet bulb on the schedule in the instrument instructions, and at least every two weeks, which is the frequency in the model. The water-activity meter is checked on its salt standard before each use.
- Direct observation. At least once a week, Jesús Canales or the HACCP-trained person watches the monitor take a cooking reading and a water-activity reading.
- Records review. Before the lot ships, and at least once a week for the week’s logs. 9 CFR 417.4(a)(2) and 417.5(c).
- Reassessment. At least once a year, and when the beef source, the formula, the oven, the thickness, the package, or the intended user changes. The reassessment is done by the HACCP-trained person. The plan is signed again. 9 CFR 417.4(a)(3) and 417.2(d).

Lots reviewed for initial validation: _____

Oven and fullest load: _____

HACCP-trained person and date: _____

Jesús Canales and date — this is the validation date: _____

7. Principle 7 — Records

9 CFR 417.5. The hazard analysis, this plan, and the support documents are kept for the life of the plan. Monitoring records for this shelf-stable product are kept for at least two years (9 CFR 417.5(e) (1)). After six months they may be stored off site if they can be back on site within 24 hours of an FSIS request. Each entry is made when the event happens and includes the date, the time, and the initials. The value written is the value read. A blank, a check mark, or the word “yes” where a number belongs is not a complete record.

Pre-shipment review, 9 CFR 417.5(c): before the lot ships, a person reviews that lot’s records, writes that every critical limit was met or that the corrective action is finished, and signs and dates the review. Where practical, that person did not produce the record. The lot does not ship until this review says it may ship.

8. Signature — 9 CFR 417.2(d)

The responsible establishment official signs and dates this plan on first acceptance, after any change, and at least once a year at reassessment. The signature means the establishment will implement the plan. The plan is not signed until the HACCP-trained person is named and the sanitation SOP names the *Listeria* alternative.

Jesús Canales, responsible establishment official: _____

Date: _____

HACCP-trained person: _____

Date: _____

9. Forms

9.1 Cooking log — CCP 1

Reading	Lot result
Date, time, and lot	
Time the product entered the heated oven	
Time the dampers closed (within 30 minutes)	
Time the dampers opened. Sealed time is at least 1 hour or 50 percent of the cook, whichever is longer.	
Wet bulb at least 125°F for at least 1 hour. Write the readings.	
Relative humidity at least 27 percent for at least 1 hour. Write the number.	
Time internal temperature rose from 50°F to above 130°F. Limit: 6 hours or less.	
Coldest spot, thickest piece, internal °F, and the minutes it stayed at or above 145°F. Limit: at least 4 minutes.	
Monitor initials	

9.2 Drying log — CCP 2

Dry bulb during drying at least 170°F. Highest of at least six pieces: 0.85 or less.

Lot	Dry bulb °F	aw 1	aw 2	aw 3	aw 4	aw 5	aw 6	Highest aw	Initials

9.3 Cooler log — prerequisite, not a CCP

Product temperature below 41°F. Probe in the meat.

Date / time	Lot	Where (receipt, cooler, marinade)	Product °F	Initials

9.4 Pre-shipment review

Check	Met / Not met	Number on the log
Product stayed below 41°F		
Dampers closed within 30 minutes and stayed closed long enough		
Wet bulb at least 125°F for at least 1 hour		
Relative humidity at least 27 percent for at least 1 hour		
Come-up 6 hours or less		
Internal at least 145°F for at least 4 minutes		
Drying dry bulb at least 170°F		
Highest of six water-activity readings 0.85 or less		
Calibration acceptable, sanitation signed		
Corrective action closed if there was a miss		

Lot: _____

Reviewer, date, and time: _____

Ship? Yes or No: _____

9.5 Corrective action

417.3 item	Entry
Date, time, CCP, lot, limit, and the number read	
Product held? Where?	
Cause, and what was fixed before the next lot	
How the CCP is back under control	
What will stop a repeat	
Disposition. No injurious product is shipped. A failed cook is not sold as jerky.	
Signatures: monitor and Jesús Canales	

Support kept with this plan: 9 CFR Parts 317, 412, and 417; FSIS Guideline for Label Approval, FSIS-GD-2025-0006; the seven FSIS guidelines named in the opening table; the jerky field verification checklist; Principles of Preservation of Shelf-Stable Dried Meat Products.

CHART 1 · Process flow

Ready-to-eat beef jerky · Delta, UT

The customer does not cook it. It contains beef. It is sold shelf-stable, without refrigeration.

Light box = process step **Green box = critical control point** **Red box = the lot does not ship**



If a CCP limit is missed, the lot is held and is not sold as ready-to-eat beef jerky.

CHART 2 · The three limits

From the FSIS beef jerky HACCP model, 2021-0004, and Appendix A

Point	What is measured	The lot passes if
Prerequisite	Product temperature	Below 41°F. Not a CCP.
CCP 1 Cooking	Internal temperature	145°F or above for at least 4 minutes
CCP 1 Cooking	Wet bulb	At least 125°F for at least 1 hour
CCP 1 Cooking	Relative humidity	At least 27% for at least 1 hour
CCP 1 Cooking	Sealed oven	Dampers closed within 30 minutes, and kept closed for 1 hour or 50% of the cook, whichever is longer
CCP 1 Cooking	Come-up time	From 50°F to 130°F, 6 hours or less
CCP 2 Drying	Dry bulb	At least 170°F during drying
CCP 2 Drying	Water activity	0.85 or less. Highest of at least six pieces.

A blank or the word “yes” does not count. The measured number has to be written. If a CCP number is missing, the lot does not ship. 9 CFR 417.5.

Carne Seca Jesus Canales, LLC · 411 E Main St, Delta, UT 84624 · Limits from the FSIS beef jerky HACCP model (2021-0004) and Appendix A (December 2021).